

1.7 CSS syntax

Even though there are many alternatives to how CSS can be written compared to what we will see now, this is the most sensible way of structuring your CSS code. It will aid in navigation and debugging, and certainly make it easier for you or anyone else to revisit the CSS to make tweaks later on.

```
p {  
  color: red;  
}
```

Rule 1: After the selector, the property and value are contained within curly braces.

Rule 2: A semi-colon always follows the declaration.

Rule 3: In the declaration, the

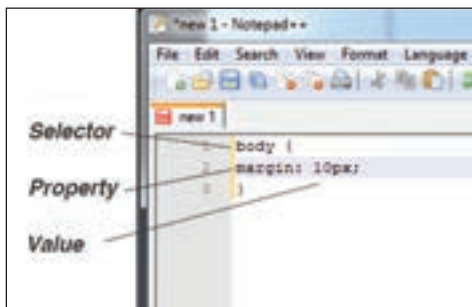
Property (color) is followed by a colon, followed by a value (red).

Failing to include the rules in curly braces or missing the colon or semi colon will result in errors. Additional properties and values for the selector can be added within the curly braces.

```
p {  
  color: red;  
  font-size: 12px;  
}
```

Now all the paragraphs will be red and have a set font size of 12 pixels. The selector (in this case the p) acts as the link between the CSS and the HTML, and as a result all paragraphs will be styled accordingly. Note that the selector is defined in lowercase, as required by XHTML only, as HTML is case insensitive.

For now, we'll concentrate on how a style sheet is structured. The basic templates you have created in this chapter will be useful as a starting point for other future examples. 



The correct CSS syntax